

OPERATIONAL SUMMARY: Library Digitization & Asset Protection Pilot

In Collaboration with: Wolaita Zone Science & Technology Office (WZSIT)

Target: Secondary Education Bureau Leadership

1. CONTEXT

Public school libraries house critical educational assets. Currently, the lack of modern tracking tools leads to unaccounted losses and administrative burdens for librarians. This initiative introduces a tool designed to protect these assets without adding workload.

2. CORE BENEFITS TO THE BUREAU

- **Real-Time Accountability:** Precise tracking of book inventory and borrower history.
- **Automated Reporting:** Generate month-end reports in seconds rather than days.
- **No Infrastructure Burden:** Works entirely offline; no internet installation is required for daily use.
- **Standardized Identity:** Integrates with **Fayda National ID**, aligning schools with the national digital identity roadmap.

3. THE "SYSTEM-FIRST" APPROACH

It is important to note that current library challenges are not a reflection of school performance; they are a result of **outdated tools**. By providing librarians with digital tools, we empower them to focus on student support rather than manual record-keeping.

4. PILOT PROPOSAL

WZSIT and the development team propose a **Limited Observation Pilot**:

- **Duration:** 3 Months.
- **Scope:** 1–2 Selected Secondary Schools.
- **Supervision:** Technical support provided entirely by WZSIT.
- **Bureau Role:** Observation of data accuracy and impact on asset preservation.

Recommendation: Approval to begin school-level data encoding for the observation phase.